LOGISTICIAN GUIDE TO PERSONAL GROWTH

Develop and expand upon your many strengths to create your desired future

16Personalities

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Introduction

Why Personal Growth Matters to Logisticians

Logisticians have great practical skills, and they're not afraid to use them. Their motto could be: "A little hard work never hurt anyone." Anybody who needs a job completed painstakingly couldn't do better than a Logistician. In a nutshell, they believe in keeping order and upholding traditional values and ideas. They stick to the rules and, although it goes against their Introverted nature, they'll even speak up if they feel that someone else is neglecting those standards. Most of all, they notice what they need to do to fulfill their obligations, and then they do it.

Loyalty, Reliability, and Honesty

When it comes to personal growth, Logisticians have plenty of great raw material to work with in the form of loyalty, reliability, and honesty. There is an air of honesty about everything that they do. They are perhaps the most honest of all personality types, always telling the truth, even if their honesty can be a little stern at times. Add their loyalty and reliability to this, and you have the three pillars that support their world.

These strengths get Logisticians up in the morning and then define their days. Growth simply involves developing and expanding these strengths, much like athletes develop their skills and muscles, to create a more positive future.

In the pages ahead, we'll discuss how Logisticians can harness their many gifts – including their loyalty, reliability, and honesty – to grow into the people they most want to be. We'll also cover how Logisticians can move past the stumbling blocks, both internal and external, that inevitably arise along the way. Our hope is that these insights will enable Logisticians to build the effective, values-driven lives that they feel called to lead.

Curious about the traits that make up your personality type and the theory behind them? You can learn more here.

The Core Motivating Factors

There are three core motivating factors: self-esteem, self-respect, and self-confidence. These are the things that drive Logisticians to grow. These motivating factors involve Logisticians seeing themselves in a particular manner or being a certain person. For example, if a person values being honest, they will value themselves more if they consistently tell the truth and approach life with a high measure of sincerity. This is a well-balanced approach.

If they feel that they are floundering in the life, they may begin to tell the truth in an unnecessarily stark and brutal manner. It's a misguided attempt (sometimes not even conscious) to emphasize that they are honest people. This exaggerated honesty will temporarily allow them to feel valued or righteous but is likely to lead them to an undesirable place in the end. "Unbalanced" usually involves relying on traits and values in an extreme fashion. Normally commendable traits are unbalanced simply because they are applied too generously, and consequently, things go off-kilter.

When things are not well balanced, there comes a time to "rebalance." Honesty can be tempered with kindness, losing none of its authenticity but gaining much in the way of tact. In this chapter, we discuss how each core motivating factor can appear when balanced and unbalanced, and what can be done to rebalance when needed.

Self-Esteem

Simply put, self-esteem concerns liking what people see in their mental mirror. It asks the question: "Do I like myself because of the way I conduct my life and the way I express myself in the world?" People who build appreciation for themselves through their actions will likely choose the right path of growth.

Balanced Self-Esteem

Doing Good by the Rules

Logisticians find their self-esteem in their drive to do good by making the world effective for themselves and those they care about. Because of their Thinking bent, it doesn't matter so much whether others agree

with them or not. As long as they believe that they are doing what they can to uphold traditions, rules, and standards, they don't need the approval of others. They just have to approve of their own actions. Unlike many people who might see rules as somewhat arbitrary, Logisticians deeply hold that set standards are essential to the world being a better place. For Logisticians, when they safeguard these standards, they see themselves as contributing to the well-being of themselves and other people – a very admirable thing to do.

Diligent Attention

In everyday life, this means that Logisticians strive to maintain standards and make sure that people (themselves especially) do things as they should – "should" being an established standard in the culture involved. Their need for self-esteem will motivate them to oversee their work with diligent attention to protocols and expectations and to raise a family or live a private life dedicated to upholding conventional principles for living.

Unbalanced Self-Esteem

Doubling Down on Standards

If Logisticians find themselves not liking what they see in their mental mirrors, for whatever reasons, as a reaction, they may double down on reinforcing set standards. Unfortunately, this can awaken a zealous rigidity. Logisticians can take an asset and allow it to overheat in an attempt to make up for what they believe is lost ground.

Being a stickler is a good thing. It's admirable to get things reasonably right. Being too much of stickler, however, can overwhelm people and result in an attempt to remove any human element, like emotions, from one's endeavors. "We must work harder and let the rules guide us exactly as they are written," communicated in a severe tone, can be dehumanizing. A Logistician might reason, "If this makes me like myself better, insisting others do the same will help them as well. I'm persisting for their own good." Unfortunately, different types of people have unique ideas about the qualities that contribute to their self-esteem. In such cases, this Logistician may simply come across as

nagging and unpleasant rather than the well-intentioned companions and colleagues that they may intend to be.

The Dark Path of Surrender

As an alternative path, Logisticians who pursue this rigidity to the point of misery and failure for themselves or others may surrender to a darker impulse. They may give into an "all or nothing" mindset. If their trying too hard makes things ineffective, they may throw up their hands and declare that any degree of trying is simply useless.

While Logisticians certainly have a deserved reputation for being hardworking, they don't often find their motivations for that work from some fount of ambition within themselves. If their time-honored tactics fail, it's probable that they will see their motivation disappear along with their lack of success. For Logisticians, the cliché "success breeds success" can be something they find themselves taking quite seriously, even if on a subconscious level. There are many external things that inspire them, and their own past successes at being effective are among them. Being too rigid can be a recipe for failure and, consequently, a means of eroding motivation.

Rebalancing Self-Esteem

Enlisting the help of a trusted friend who is capable of a degree of objectivity can be helpful when Logisticians become too rigid. If Logisticians are struggling with restoring a sense of self-esteem, it may be difficult for them to see that they are doing so in a manner that may be harmful to themselves (rendering them ineffective) and others (emotionally, morale).

Help from an Objective Other

The help of an objective individual can do two things: First, they can help Logisticians gauge the intensity of their adherence to standards. They can help them see when it is all too much. Logisticians don't always pick up emotional cues, and rules are more interesting to them, and so they focus there instead. So, if the people in their lives are unhappy, the objective other can slow things down and help their Logistician friends

focus a little more on the human element involved. They can help gain the perspective of other people, which may lead to a greater measure of empathy.

Secondly, they can work together to assess tactics and decide what works and what doesn't. This analysis can help Logisticians escape any vicious cycles they might be in and to concentrate on those methods which are successful.

Taking Inventory

To help Logisticians deal with any concerns they have with liking themselves, they may want to spend time writing a list of the ways their actions benefit others. Their effect on others may be direct and personal, but it's more likely to be indirect and involve supporting a system. It doesn't matter. Both ways involve doing good, and a list helps them remember who they are. The list can help them quantify that they are someone who deserves their own esteem.

Self-Respect

Self-respect involves people finding value in themselves. With low self-respect, they feel that they lack worth. With high self-respect, their sense of value is firmly intact, and they feel that they are fulfilling their purpose in life.

Balanced Self-Respect

Reliability, Trustworthiness, and Self-Respect

Logisticians' self-respect comes from their reliability and trustworthiness. People with this personality like to believe that they fulfill their duties honestly while conforming to all established standards. Of all the things a person can be, Logisticians choose to be dependable and consistent above any other qualities, and when they make that choice in a balanced fashion, they grow.

Finding Worth in Protocols

To best fortify their self-respect, Logisticians may choose a job heavy on protocols and methods. Public service, military, medicine, office

management, and education are among the careers that might fit them well – anything where they can exercise their valued reliability and trustworthiness. For Logisticians, it is an even better fit if the job involves a measure of problem-solving and has an established routine. At home, they feed their self-respect by seeking out a traditional life where they can fill the role of "pillar of the community" by simply being reliably stable and playing by the rules.

Unbalanced Self-Respect

Should Logisticians begin to worry about the quality of their reliability or trustworthiness, they are likely to search for some means of pumping up their sense of worth. In an attempt to restore their flagging self-respect, they can become somewhat demanding about their precision, affecting both themselves and others. They may set standards for themselves that are impossible to reach and put success beyond their grasp. Obviously, if they meet with failure due to impossible standards, their self-respect will only continue to suffer, perhaps starting a vicious cycle.

Pushing to Perfectionistic Extremes

Sometimes, situations demand perfection – neurosurgery, for example. But many other situations can suffer from the need to perform too precisely and perfectly. Logisticians can push themselves to perfectionistic extremes, especially when they have something to prove to themselves. During these times, they may tell themselves that they are pursuing excellence. Since perfect is a rare commodity, Logisticians can postpone the end of projects forever waiting for elusive perfection. Similarly, procrastination often comes from a perfectionist having a gut sense that they will not perform perfectly. Mistakes may happen. Consequently, they postpone the pain of what they view as an inevitable failure which is a realistic analysis if all a person expects is perfection. Similarly, they may never find satisfaction in anything that they do, and this can demoralize them.

The Effects on Others

Once they begin pushing themselves so hard, Logisticians may insist everybody else also comply with their impossible measures – especially if they are in a management position. As suggested above, if there is a

need for Logisticians to prove their honesty, they may transform from being those who others rely on for the truth to being those who shine a harsh light on things that are better left alone. Important individuals in Logisticians' lives may choose to avoid honest interactions rather than invite judgment – potentially closing down open communication.

Rebalancing Self-Respect

Good Enough

Perfectionism almost naturally simmers in the background of Logisticians' lives, with all of their standards and rules to maintain. When self-respect is out of balance, they may need to guard against allowing fastidiousness to take over their lives. While it is hard for Logisticians to embrace the idea that sometimes good enough is, indeed, good enough, finding a way to do so will restore balance.

To counter perfectionistic tendencies, Logisticians might question the black-and-white extremes that push such standards. "What's the worst thing that could happen if this report isn't the absolute best report ever written? What if I miss a minor detail or two?" Creating a list of all the things that could go wrong and the related consequences may prove to be enlightening because people's worries rarely come to pass. The world is more forgiving than perfectionistic Logisticians allow themselves to imagine. Often the worst outcome from doing something is that one learns that "do-overs" are allowed more often than not.

Giving Well-Deserved Breaks

Logisticians may want to give themselves a break and find a more realistic perspective and extend the same attitude to those around them. Logisticians do well to remember that those among their family members, coworkers, friends, and others are likely to be more effective in their roles when they are happy and feeling confident.

Finally, when Logisticians begin to feel a twinge of doubt over their reliability and trustworthiness, sitting down with an objective other can help them restore a realistic perspective. Finding someone they trust to help assess any aspect of life where they have concerns can provide them with a healthy objective view.

Self-Confidence

Balanced Self-Confidence

Confidence from Respectability

Self-confidence concerns trusting one's abilities. One is less likely to move forward if they have low self-confidence and more likely move forward if they have more. For Logisticians, self-confidence comes from a sense of respectability. If they feel valued, it motivates them to do more.

Respectability refers to others respecting an individual, and this can be somewhat foreign territory for Logisticians who can be socially reticent. As long as things are going well, it's possible for Logisticians to remain fairly invisible in a room. The right interactions may be necessary for them to know others respect them, and getting recognition can become a big deal.

A Sense of Duty

However, Logisticians rarely seek recognition. Doing so makes little sense to them because it's not part of their primary motivation. They see all they do as an expected duty. For them, that would be like others celebrating that they brushed their teeth when they rose in the morning. It's just what one does. While Logisticians may humbly protest when others try to show appreciation for their conscientiousness, it likely pleases them and gives them a sense that they are valued. Consequently, this strengthens their self-confidence.

A Little Goes a Long Way

Fortunately, for their self-confidence, Logisticians don't need much. They don't need a brass band or large gathering of celebrants. In fact, either of those would likely make them uncomfortable. A simple "thank you and well done" makes Logistician happy and subtly fortifies their resolve. All they need for confidence is the simple belief that they are valuable individuals to others.

Unbalanced Self-Confidence

Resentful Duty

While the amount of recognition one gets might sound like a vanity concern, it can go deeper. For Logisticians, it's important to know that their good work is working. Without some expression of appreciation, people can forget they belong or have a purpose. Motivation ideally comes from within, but humans are social animals, and they are the rare individuals who don't desire some recognition for their contributions. Logisticians need to know that their hard work is appreciated.

Logisticians who don't feel recognition for their work may imagine others not caring about what they do, that someone is taking advantage of them, or that they aren't a vital part of a group. It can cause their confidence to falter. And since Logisticians don't typically like to confront others, they may allow these concerns to fester. Lack of recognition can disrupt their sense of belonging, draining both energy and enthusiasm that feeds into confident behavior.

Artificially Proving Importance

The first is proving one's importance. The first is proving one's importance. Pushing one's reputation by inflating one's importance can take a wrong turn if it feels forced and care is not taken to soften it. As an exaggerated example, think of the stereotypical TV sitcom version of the bureaucrat behind the counter at the DMV who won't cut the customer a break under any circumstances nor will they even take the time to hear them out. The hidden message is, "See I'm important enough to belong here." On TV, they exaggerate situations for laughs. Milder, more realistic versions might seep into the everyday life of some Logisticians if they aren't getting the recognition they deserve.

The second is passive-aggressive behavior. That's striking out at others by not doing something as an alternative to a direct assault. The person who typically makes a beautiful breakfast every day suddenly presents undercooked eggs with blackened toast. The hidden message, "Now you'll pay attention when I do it well." (And the cook may not even do it consciously.)

People will usually find a way to feel valued – even if they have to do so in maladaptive ways. If it feels like Logisticians are forcing others to acknowledge their value, it will come across as demanding and abrasive. Finding a more wholesome way of accomplishing the same thing can create pleasant experiences and help cement respectful relationships.

Rebalancing Self-Confidence

The Basic Need for Recognition

A sense of belonging is a basic human need, and Logisticians are notoriously weak at self-promotion. And yet their self-confidence depends on the sense that others value what they do. Aided by their Introverted qualities, they can easily fade into the background if they are not careful. Some people are naturals at self-promotion, and some people are not. To that end, "Self-promotion for Introverts" is now a thing on the Internet.

For some people, self-promotion might be thought of as a stress-management technique because it helps individuals relax more into their lives and feel more comfortable in their skins. Rather than experiencing stress at feeling left behind because the Extraverts seem to be hogging all the glory, Logisticians and other Introverts may want to explore strategies for getting the attention they deserve. Getting attention can help them get ahead and feel like a vital part of any group to which they belong. For Logisticians, recognition provides a potential boost to their self-confidence.

Relating to One's Self and Others

At first, Logisticians may want to promote themselves to... themselves. Taking inventory of one's value can be the first step to gaining the confidence needed to shine publicly. Even if self-promotion goes no further, Logisticians can assure themselves of their belonging in a group as a valuable member.

Logisticians can be insular, and that alone can cause them to fade into the wallpaper. But they still value relationships. If they can think of self-promotion as part of a relationship, they might find it easier to tell others who they are and what they do. This perspective may feel less

like they are "blowing their own horn" and more like they are sharing themselves openly with others.

The Elevator Pitch

And, lastly, there's the old reliable elevator speech: the 30-second speech that one might give during the span of typical elevator ride that sums up who the one giving the pitch is. It is a way to brand oneself and to get others to pay healthy attention. Logisticians don't have to confine their elevator pitches to professional use.

As an example, Bobby's Logistician dad might present himself to Bobby's fifth-grade teacher and other parents at the PTA meeting in the following fashion: "I'm Bobby's dad, chauffeur, knee-scrape doctor, and home study hall supervisor. While he depends on his mom to help him with everyday homework, I'm around for his larger projects. So, if the diorama doesn't cut it, you can blame Bobby, but my hand was involved in the crime as well." (Obviously, running around a room repeating this can sound odd, so variations on a theme are acceptable and perhaps preferred.)

This pitch is a breezy yet defining description of what Bobby's dad does for him. It's even slightly self-effacing for those who are more comfortable being humble. Bobby's dad may have a work version of this or even a golf course version. It's like a commercial slogan that repeats the speakers' attributes and gives others a chance to know them and their role in the group. It can be very effective at bringing someone who is usually in the background more to the forefront.

Specific Growth Areas

Self-Responsibility

Balanced Self-Responsibility

Logisticians' sense of responsibility comes from their need to honor their rational approach to tradition and accepted principles. In a sense, their duty to the world around them is the same as their duty to themselves. Logisticians' personal sense of responsibility and their obligation to society can't be fully separated. In some sense, they take care of themselves when they take care of the world. Fulfilling their sense of responsibility can help them achieve strong self-esteem, self-respect, and self-confidence.

A Drive to Stabilize

Whether at home or work, Logisticians experience a drive to stabilize. They may not be ambitious in any conventional sense of the word. But that doesn't mean they lack drive. Their drive to achieve is a stoic push that is fueled by the intention to keep things as steady as possible.

Logisticians have a connection to standards, rules, and tradition that is stronger than most. It's not excessive to say the Logisticians of the world buttress social contracts and conventions. They may not even view themselves as responsible for such things in any conscious manner, but they accept the responsibility anyway. For them, it's just what one does. No matter what their actual profession, some part of them plays the contract lawyer who keeps everyone honest.

Masters of Organization and Standards

Organization comes naturally to Logisticians. They know what to do and who to call to make things happen smoothly. They tend to have an all-encompassing overview of resources that they become familiar with and achieve mastery over. This helps them organize efficiently. At home and as parents, they are likely to have just as much of a command of resources.

This attention to detail is not for its own sake. Logisticians link it to responsibility and making sure that everything fits with the relevant goals and standards. Life for them is often a series of rubrics, arranged and linked to provide an organized and consistent path.

The Value of Persistence

Logisticians enjoy the gift of patience and focus. They are valiant in their ability to push through even at some personal sacrifice. The most mundane work is no problem for Logisticians if they grasp its rational purpose, if it fits a paradigm with which they are familiar, or if it's paired with a powerful sense of obligation.

Logisticians' persistence presents value in many ways. While they may not always find motivation from within, once engaged, they are finishers, and the simple idea that something will be left undone if they don't is a strong motivator. People with the Judging trait find satisfaction in chapters that are completed and closed. Being persistent enough to complete a task reinforces their sense of reliability and, consequently, their self-esteem.

Unbalanced Self-Responsibility

Personal and professional growth occurs when Logisticians use their sense of responsibility and dedication to move forward in life. However, as with all good things, diligence can shift from a powerful tool to a demanding tyrant if not properly balanced against other considerations.

Too Little Self-Care

Logisticians build their self-esteem and confidence upon their successful execution of responsibilities and their upholding of established standards. When they are not feeling great about themselves or their lives, their sense of responsibility, which takes the form of reinforcing standards, may "overheat" as they search for a more positive sense of themselves. Instead of integrating self-care and rest into their lives, they may feel an urgency to perform and go in the opposite direction, pushing themselves relentlessly.

At such times, Logisticians may forget the softer side of dealing with people including themselves – the side where gentle coaxing is more effective than harsh mandates. Logisticians are not always in touch with their feelings. Logisticians leaning too hard on their standards may appear unreasonable to those with other priorities or styles."

Even Logisticians, all of whom tend to be stalwart, become stressed when tensions from their overbearing attitudes break down the morale, the willingness, and the effectiveness of others. When they hold to absolute standards regardless of others' personal circumstances, it can erode the morale, the willingness, and the effectiveness of the very people Logisticians depend on most. Even those Logisticians may not readily identify with the ideas; such breakdowns can start vicious cycles where they are disappointed in their performance, feel stressed about it, and then go deeper into burnout. The type who always knows what to do finds itself without a solution.

Rebalancing Self-Responsibility

Assessment: Is the Stress Worth It?

Logisticians who find themselves suffering from taking on too much responsibility may need to assess who they are, what their duties are, and why they feel a need to push so hard. They also might want to decide if their relentless efforts are paying off or not. Working exceedingly hard may indeed be the right thing to do at times. But it can also exact a toll on an individual. Matching the cost to the benefit is essential. It can be counter-productive for Logisticians to assume that strenuous and overbearing attention to something is the lone solution to all concerns. The cliché about working smarter rather than working harder comes into play.

Logisticians will typically choose action over ruminating over things. The action doesn't necessarily have to be bold. It could be as simple as tying up a loose end or attending to minute details that need completing. A little action can be reassuring. For them, there is the familiar, time-honored tactic of simply doing. It doesn't matter if it's just busywork if there is some level of contribution involved. However, this go-to tactic may not be helpful when stress is the result of doing too much. Learning to prioritize the actions which have proven to be important and balancing it with down time and relaxation can make this tactic more responsible. A shell of a Logistician is less effective than one who has been restored. Asking "why?" instead of pursuing less considered busyness can help set a clearer path – especially when Logisticians' need to feel responsible begins to "overheat" and results in an explosion of activity.

Stress Management: Proven Results

"We must have a pie. Stress cannot exist in the presence of a pie," wrote playwright David Mamet with tongue in cheek. Nonetheless, stress management is about baking the particular pie that offsets a particular stress. This might take the form of lunch with a good friend, having a good physical workout after a strenuous session hitting the books, or simply taking a walk in the country. It's about finding a cozy, sheltered kitchen, metaphorically speaking, in one's life where Logisticians can restore balance and a sense of being strong and whole rather than beat up and torn down. And everyone likes pie.

To convince Logisticians of the value of dealing with stress, it may be important to emphasize that stress management is not called "stress elimination." Logistician value reasonable stress. When balanced, it has its place, and Logisticians are well aware of that it keeps them alert and motivated. It is only problematic when stressors are no other choices are available. It is something to be managed but not necessarily sidestepped.

Often hardworking people like Logisticians roll their eyes at the concept of stress-management courses, but stress-management is about becoming more productive in one's life – a thing Logisticians value. It should streamline actions to those that are necessary, balance obligation with self-care and promote a wiser use of physical and mental energy. A thorough stress-management course not only teaches how to deal with stress in the moment. It can also help Logisticians plan their days, weeks, months, even their entire lives, in a way that allows them to pace themselves better.

However, first Logisticians need to recognize when their plate is too full. "Too much" is different for everyone even within the same personality types since several factors affect stamina and motivation. Obvious signs might be exhaustion, quick-tempers, or anxious feelings of dread becoming normal. Some Logisticians who are over-extended might even find themselves physically ill more often.

Interested Logisticians can find stress management material online, and human resources and counselors at many companies and schools can offer help. Methods to relieve stress are dependent on a person's

needs, preferences, and problems specific to a particular lifestyle. There are countless methods that can be accessed, including anything from deep breathing/meditation to life planning to assertiveness training to finding ways to bring more recreation and relaxation into one's life. Most are experiential and call for action more than explanation. There is little about stress-management that is "one-size-fits-all." The upside to that is there are techniques available that fit every individual's style. However, below are some preliminary steps to stress management for consideration: Breathing, Prioritizing/goal setting and finding time for oneself.

4-7-8 Breathing

"Fight or Flight," a phrase often used to discuss stress, is a remnant of human ancestors' will to survive. Anyone who has ever been alone in a house at night and hears a noise is familiar with the concept. During such events, people stop breathing for just a second. They perhaps tense up. The hairs on their arms and necks stand up. For a microsecond, they are as alert as any of their ancestors listening for a tiger in the bushes.

The reaction to stress can be very physical. Modern man has transferred the same reactions to things that aren't necessarily a physical threat. They may become tense, for example, when they see an email from their supervisor or their exes and halt their breath for just a moment. Stressed people often breathe more shallowly.

When Logisticians find themselves stressed out, one intervention might include a physical one. 4-7-8 breathing is easy to do anywhere and great "first aid" for when the stress levels are noticeably high. There are four simple steps:

1. Breath in through the nose for a count of four.
2. Hold the breath for a count of seven.
3. Breath out through the mouth making a soft "whooshing" sound for a count of eight.
4. Repeat three more times.

Of course, this is not a comprehensive solution of any kind. But it can allow Logisticians to slow down, to relax their physical reactions to stress, and to feel less stressed, and sometimes that's enough to help during a moment.

Setting Priorities and Goals

People caught up in the throes of perfectionism sometimes see all their priorities as having equal weight. Making a list of priorities, from the most important to the least, can help Logisticians assess what they are doing. It's unreasonable to think that everything deserves the same amount of attention and effort, and people tend to sort those things out naturally. However, when Logisticians feel the need to overcompensate, they may try for total perfection. Remembering that some things are just not that important and can be temporarily ignored or delegated to someone else can help them scrape some of the stress off their plates.

However, it is not enough to simply knows one's priorities or to make lists. The next step is a thoughtful action plan made up of a series of goals. An action plan is at its best if it's a living document that is flexible with details and depends on an awareness of the big picture. It should be able to handle unanticipated new information without losing its primary direction. For a Logistician, it is tempting to create an iron-clad list of actions and intents, but without a reasonable degree of flexibility built-in, it can end up working against them by creating even more stress.

Once Logisticians separate that which is important from the things which are less so, they can begin to determine goals to deal the priorities that need the most attention. Breaking the goals down into smaller "baby steps" using the time-honored SMART guidelines (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant and Time-bound) can help Logisticians hit some of their targets. A clean direction with manageable and measurable steps can do wonders toward taming overwhelming stress.

Taking Time Off

Sometimes a break is all a person needs to reduce stress. With the help of technology, people tend always to be "on." If it's not the job,

it's the family. If it's not the family, it's friends with problems. It's hard to get away from the things that keep people on their toes and feeling responsible. Learning to turn off the phone and the laptop occasionally can help Logisticians leave their sometimes overbearing sense of responsibility behind for a short time. In life, everything may feel like an emergency, but it's not really. Most of the time, it's okay to put matters on hold for a little while or let others worry about it for a while. The only difference will be the vigor and the more positive outlook that Logisticians will return with. Taking time for a walk in nature without a phone or watching a movie without a tablet can be revitalizing. Even better, the luxury of a week away from it all can be just what is needed.

Self-Determination

Self-determination is the act of deciding one's own path in life. When people choose satisfying and successful paths, it is primarily because their choices have met their self-esteem, self-respect, and self-confidence needs. By definition, this involves a degree of independent thought in that one's self rather than some external measure. It's all about choice and decision making. And therein lies what makes self-determination and interesting challenge for the rule-bound logisticians.

Balanced Self-Determination

Logisticians have confidence in the things they believe to be true. Their rational natures encourage them to embrace that which makes sense to them and those things which have proven track records. Logisticians embrace standards and rules based on the assumption that those who went before have tried them and found them effective. No doubt, they will put their spin on them, but the established ideas and methods are foundational to their life decisions.

Motivating Principles

Like a three-legged stool, Logisticians' practical combination of Observant and Judging traits, along with the Thinking trait, helps them meet their goals. Their rationality gifts them with the objective distance that can be useful when hard decisions or concrete results are required. Somebody has to make the hard calls and enforce the rules.

They shine when situations call for putting emotional considerations on the back burner, at least for a time. While this approach sounds stern, the motivation behind it must be acknowledged. Logisticians want the outcome to be successful, and they see success as the product of playing by the rules. When the outcome is successful, everyone involved wins. Even it is a strict approach; it is benevolently so.

Logisticians determine their course by the way things "should be." When balanced, they recognize established rites of passage and the steps required for a fruitful life. Professionally, they may take the right courses and get the right degrees to move them forward. In their personal lives, it may be cultural expectations of the type of home they live in, the communities they belong to and maybe even the number of kids in the household. They measure their progress, not based on some passion that may be there today and disappear tomorrow, but on proven paths to stability. The map is objective, and the way is clear.

Thinking and Observing

The Thinking trait heavily influences Logisticians' decisions and, by extension, their self-determination. They assess a situation accurately through their Observant trait and then decide what to do with the information with their more analytical Thinking trait. These traits make them great in any position that requires that they determine the quality or completeness of something. As long as they remain aware of their biases toward the conventional, this can aid them in determining the own right direction.

Unbalanced Self-Determination

Dismissing the Emotional Factors

Mother Nature has evolved humanity into a species that roils with emotions. People ignore this aspect of humankind to their peril. Emotions provide people important information and help to motivate them to seek the fulfilling and to avoid the dangerous. Logisticians who invest too greatly in their rules and rationality may discover that they are dismissing something which is essential to the people around them.

Possessing the Thinking trait does not indicate an absence of feelings, but rather a preference for deciding things rationally over the preference for deciding from a more emotional perspective. However, if this preference is excessive, Logisticians' rules and the standards may become more important than the feelings and egos of the people they affect. They may think in the stark terms of "rules" and "not rules" and miss any in-between spaces where empathy might dwell. In seeking cooperation with the rules, they may instead create bad feelings which lead to a sense of alienation and distance. In the name of cooperation comes the opposite.

When individuals place rationality above the emotional needs of people, there is an assumption that one style is better than the other. In truth, they both have a place. To deny that is to deny the value and the contribution of others. Logisticians who push their standards as the only reasonable consideration are telling others that neither their approach nor their feelings matter. Dismissing them injures more than just the other's pride. It can also damage their sense of belonging.

Losing Oneself to the Rules

In their attempt to play it by the rules, Logisticians may also find themselves in a type of identity crisis. If life is so planned and the standards so carefully laid out, the individual might become lost. One's uniqueness may become swallowed up by a cookie cutter life of rules.

A person always going with the flow can feel more like a cog in a machine than a human being. While even within types there are different levels of tolerance for "following the beat of a different drummer," Logisticians may become so consumed by standards that the rules won't allow them to wander very far off a well-beaten path. Being unique helps people see themselves as offering something to the world that is their own. Appreciating some degree of being different from everyone else fosters a sense of purpose. People don't like to feel they are interchangeable. Nobody likes to think that someone else could just be plugged into their lives and nothing would be different. Logisticians will have special personalities just like anyone else. But if they allow their lives to become determined so completely by a pre-set path with pre-set standards, they may lose some of that motivational sense of identity and purpose. Eventually, Logisticians who have broader experiences

will eventually ask themselves the right questions about their roles in the world. Midlife crises often emerge out of just this sort of thing.

Forgetting Biases

Logisticians who forget their bias toward the conventional may limit their decision-making options. It's fine to have a preference toward that which is consistent and tradition-bound But to assume that preference encompasses all viable choices automatically sets limits. Limits are not inherently bad, but if bias only allows people to see there is only X, Y, and Z for choices, but, in reality, A, B, and C exist as well, the quality and range of choices may not be complete. By definition, this limits self-determination. The effective direction might include a little of B, for example, and the only thing stopping a higher degree of effectiveness is a bias toward X, Y, and Z.

Rebalancing Self-Determination

Reconciling the Heart with the Head

So, often people present the differences between the mind and the emotions as separated by something impenetrable that never allow the two. That's a false set-up and Logisticians who understand that there can be a type of rationality within feelings will achieve a better balance between the two. Simply starting from rationality does not mean that there has to be a wall between that and feelings.

But none of that matters. It does matter that people have emotions and that they operate from them to some degree – even those who rely on the Thinking trait. Because of that, the smart thing to do is to recognize and honor feelings in others. If acknowledging and respecting feelings helps someone be more comfortable cooperating, that may be the most efficient route to accomplishing a task. For Logisticians, learning to negotiate the feelings of others while still sticking to standards can mean acquiring a powerful tool to use when working with others.

Acquiring that tool is more of art than science, but it does take becoming fluent in the language of emotions. A good place to start is by becoming more comfortable with one's own emotions. One way to do that is to set a random alarm app on one's watch or phone. When the alarm

sounds, make a quick note somewhere that answers this question: "How am I feeling right now?" Make sure the response is emotional rather than physical.

Once a Logistician begins paying closer attention to their feelings, it is a natural generalization to start taking the feelings of others more seriously. Beginning to understand and consider how others might emotionally react to a decision or mandate will help soften what were once considered demands into a mutually beneficial cooperative effort.

Discovering Individuality

Creative endeavors can help Logisticians discover a unique expression of their own. Hobbies and sports can help Logisticians celebrate their individuality. Accomplishments that distinguish them from their primary roles either at the job, in the home, or in the community can serve to help them develop a unique identity that is less dependent on the roles that comply with expectations. Needlepoint, carpentry, video games, tennis, watercolor painting, cartooning, writing – anything that allows Logisticians to explore parts of themselves not already defined elsewhere. As a bonus, indulging in such activities can also be a good stress-relieving break from the routine when things begin to feel stagnant and too predictable – if too predictable is possible for Logisticians.

Remembering Biases

Acknowledging one's biases does not necessarily mean giving them up or having to accept anything outside of one's leanings. The concept of remembering biases does involve honoring or not honoring preferred preconceptions. It's all a matter of choice. The famous box in cliché that people are encouraged to think outside of could easily be called "bias." Sometimes the good stuff is just beyond the edges. Taking time to define one's bias can help Logisticians know what their limitations are and perhaps it can allow them to challenge their biases, maybe just slightly, when appropriate. It's the difference between a limited range of choices and a fuller one.

Self-Adjustment

Balanced Self-Adjustment

"Self-adjustment" is more often heard in discussions of machinery and chiropractic techniques. But it can be applied to personality just as easily and is used in much the same way. It suggests when a person is out of alignment with their preferred qualities that they find a way to fix it. They bring themselves back into alignment by their own efforts.

The Protectors of Continuity

Logisticians are the watchers over a culture's traditions and accepted standards, and it speaks to their love of order and predictability. It serves to foster stability. Protocols are reliable like Logisticians themselves. If everything were in a constant state of change, then life would become messy. Imagine arriving at work every day, never knowing if the job requirements and procedures had shifted overnight. Change is important and inevitable, and the mature Logistician knows when to adapt. Within that framework, some constants and points of references must be held in place to prevent chaos. Upholding these standards are an intrinsic part of Logisticians' nature.

Without a doubt, like a love song from yesteryear or a meal that conjures pleasant memories, there is a sense of comfort in the familiar for them. Balanced Logisticians exude a perpetual sense of the foundation being in place and being exactly as it should be. Logisticians protect "what always has been" and provide society with a sense of healthy continuity.

Unbalanced Self-Adjustment

The Challenge of Change

Logisticians are practical traditionalists. However, if not balanced, this can carry dangers. Being the salt of the earth doesn't mean they own the planet. Clinging to old ideas – even as things rapidly change – can produce intolerance if Logisticians can't balance established standards with change. It may be difficult for Logisticians to view changing morals, evolving methods, and disregard for traditional standards, and not cast severe judgment in their direction. Some may perpetually pit the old against the new rather than adapt.

Change is difficult for everybody, but change hits Logisticians and other Sentinels the hardest hit when drastic shifts occur. Some Logisticians may reject change consistently, and in the 21st Century, they will undoubtedly be socially or professionally handicapped. What was once a Logistician fostering traditional standards can become rigidity. What was once a mastery of steadiness and stability can devolve into stubbornness.

Intolerance

Hate is not a natural part of Logisticians' character by any measure. Any intolerance they experience towards others is likely to be the product of fear more than disdain. If they associate a person or a group of "others" with undermining the traditional standards they fight to uphold, they may regard them as enemies. This reaction can, paradoxically, disturb the social order and all its facets that they labor so hard to create.

Rebalancing Self-Adjustment

Tradition as a Guide

W. Somerset Maugham said, "Tradition is a guide and not a jailer." This aphorism might serve as a powerful insight for Logisticians. Using it as a guide, Logisticians won't diminish their respect for tradition, but they also won't chain themselves to it either.

Accepting the inevitability of change can be the first step. Learning to blend the old with the new can help Logisticians create a more balanced view. Spotting the difference between maintaining stability and being stubborn can also help Logisticians navigate the changing world better. Self-talk and self-examination can be useful here. "Am I offering helpful insights into how things work, or am I just finding change difficult to handle?" Asking this and similar questions may help.

Reconsidering the Change Agents

Intolerance is an attitude, and there is little that combats it apart from changing one's attitude. It may help Logisticians who face this problem to look at it as a balance between efficiency and keeping things the same. Intolerance has kept many good ideas at bay. Reframing is

deciding to look at something from a different perspective: Instead of finding individuals and their different ways threatening, it might help to view them as interesting instead. Familiarity is often the scourge of intolerance. Getting to know someone or something that is hard to tolerate can be helpful.

Finally, making it a point to look for the good during change can help a lot. Searching for the silver lining and how it applies personally to Logisticians' goals and interests can make change easier for them. It may even surprise them how much the change can work in their favor.

Final Words

Like a seedling poking its head through the soil in the early spring, growth rarely happens without something emerging from the comforts of the familiar. As much as they love the familiar, Logisticians love effectiveness more. Logisticians who embrace balance and self-care will discover that they are more effective. Viewing the concept of self-care as an essential part of being effective should prove motivating for Logisticians seeking to be their best selves. People with this personality type are not slouches. They are perfectly capable of taking the risks necessary to learn and grow.

In these pages, we've outlined how people with this personality type can work on their personal development in a variety of areas. Our hope is that these insights and strategies equip Logisticians with the tools needed to find balance in their growth journey, enabling them to show up as their best selves at every stage of life.

So... What's Next?

You've reached the end of this book, but fear not – we've created many more resources for you. Here are a few that might capture your interest:

- Want more tests and insights to help you direct your personal growth journey? Explore our Personal Growth Specialized Tests.
- Looking to enhance your academic or professional life? Check out the *Logistician Guide to Careers*.
- Feeling adrift when it comes to your romantic relationships, friendships, or relationships with your children? Our *Logistician Guide to Relationships* may be just what you need.

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